

HUMAN RESOURCE

written by

Max Coyne-Green

story by

Max Coyne-Green & Mia Blake Vallet

INT. OFFICE - NIGHT

RINGING rattles off glass meeting rooms hued in greens and reds. But no Team Members are at their desks.

Not that they're really *theirs*. Hüm Automations features an open-plan office, with a range of flexible spaces for both Work and Life...

RING

...a snack-stocked kitchen, a sage-scented meditation room, and a black marble coffee bar with a barista named Kevin.

RING

But it's too late for Kevin now. And the kitchen's closed too.

Yet BASS THUMPS the floors. Punctured only by--

RINGING

from behind rows of lush bamboo, where sleek white standing desks are empty. Except, of course:

SHAE'S DESK

with its motivational sticky notes and pinned polaroids of Team Members embracing at corporate retreats...

...and the Cisco 7800 shrieking its industry-leading:

RING--

SHAE (29, accessible in a company fleece) snaps it up.

SHAE
HR, this is--

RAM (PHONE)
Shae.

The voice ripples down her spine.

RAM (PHONE) (CONT'D)
I know what you're doing.

She swirls her chair to scan the office...but it's empty.

As she spins back--

Her laptop SNAPS shut.

RAM, the 40ish Chief Operating Officer, looms over her.

RAM
Time to go.

She opens her mouth to protest.

But he just shakes his head and turns away...

...then bends forward. She exhales.

Then hops on his back for a piggyback ride down the hall.

RAM
Relax. You've practiced enough.
You're gonna crush it tomorrow.

BASS becomes MUSIC as Ram opens the door to a:

PARTY

with a bountiful buffet, a bouncing dance floor, and a gaggle of buzzed TEAMMATES. And on stage:

GUS HÜM (Founder & CEO) pacing in plain black.

GUS
--founded this company with one
simple idea: that our tools will
make us *more human* - not less.

At the buffet, THE PARTNER (60s, cargo shorts) gnashes buffalo wings. Teeth ripping sticky red flesh from the bone.

GUS (CONT'D)
That software can handle the noise,
so people can do the work.
(catching Partner's eye)
And that's only possible with the
continued support of Olympus
Capital. So, thank you.

The Partner returns a saucy smile, hands a clean bone to his hulking CONSULTANT beside him. Licks his fingers.

GUS (CONT'D)
And thank you to everyone here.
Because the real value of this
place isn't products. It's *people*.

The Partner stops licking.

Down the buffet, Shae discreetly wraps shrimp in a napkin.

SHAE'S DESK - MINUTES LATER

Shae pops open her laptop, revealing a PowerPoint deck (ShaeValue.ppt). Slides detailing 8 years of contributions and a convincing case for promotion to Vice President.

She digs into the shrimp. And clicks through the slides.

Each CLICK advancing a slide. Each slide a moment of her evening in an **OPENING SEQUENCE**:

- CLICK. Shae reviews her bio page.
- CLICK. Shae prints 12 copies.
- CLICK. A wheel rotates slowly.
- CLICK. Exercise bike. Going nowhere. Deck propped on bar.
- CLICK. Shae washes her face.
- CLICK. Shae drops her head on a pillow.
- CLICK. Shae turns off the lights.

SEQUENCE ENDS as she straps on her sleep-mask.

Shae turns over. Sinks into the pillow. Drifting off, until--
DING!

Shae sits up, confused. Peels off the sleep-mask.

Carefully tiptoes to door...

...cracks it, and peeks out to the:

MAIN FLOOR

of the OFFICE just as Gus races off the elevator.

He zips by a door marked MEDITATION ROOM but doesn't see:

Shae peering through the crack, from inside.

MEDITATION ROOM

Once he's out of sight, Shae exhales.

Through the door, a sliver of light shines on the front page of her deck, just the middle chunk of her title (Head of Human Resources), illuminating:

HUMAN RESOURCE

Shae closes the door. Room goes dark, leaving the words unreadable. She goes back to sleep.

GUS'S OFFICE - SAME

Gus hurries into his office and finds:

THE PARTNER (O.S.)
Party's over, Gus.

The Partner at his desk, licking an ice cream cone.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
It was a cute speech. But you know
the new product is the only reason
Olympus invested in this company.

The hulking CONSULTANT rises from the sofa. Gus trembles.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
Everything else is replaceable.
(lick)
Especially you.

GUS
There is no product without me.

THE PARTNER
Not yet.

The Consultant LOCKS the door behind Gus.

BLOOD DRIPS

as rare steak is sliced the next morning.

INT. OFFICE - KITCHEN - DAY

REVEAL steak being sliced in the breakfast taco buffet.

Shae joins two female JAMIES in line.

JAMIE 1	JAMIE 2
Morning Shae Shae!	Morning Shae Shae!

SHAE
Morning, Jamies.

JAMIE 1
Today the day?

Shae shrugs, coy, as they walk the taco line.

JAMIE 2
You hear about Laura?

SHAE

Laura O?

JAMIE 2

No, Laura with the--

Jamie gestures to her face area. *Ohh.*

JAMIE 2

Yeah. BetaWave just made her VP.

SHAE

Good for her. Like, *really* good.
Especially for her. You know, I
 basically taught her everything.
 And honestly--
 (overstuffing tortilla)
 --she wasn't even that good.

JAMIE 2

Good enough to be a Vice President.

SHAE

Yeah. Pulling 80 hours a week.

JAMIE 1

Looks like she's at the beach.

Jamie whips out a phone to reveal Laura's Instagram post:
 magic hour at the beach - framed by watercolor villas.

SHAE

Is that in Italy? Lucky.

JAMIE 1

You can go to the beach, Shae.

SHAE

Nice try. But people need me.

Jamies' eyes roll as--

DARA (O.S.)

Shae? I need you.

SHAE'S DESK - MINUTES LATER

Shae focuses on her PowerPoint.

Meanwhile, baby associate DARA (23, sleeves over wrists)
 stands at her shoulder, anxious.

Behind them, the WHITE BOARD reads:

Q1: LEAN IN

DARA

--and he was weird about it. Like *I* was being weird. So should I talk to him again? Or is *that* weird?

SHAE

It's only weird if you're weird. And you're not weird, Dara. You're a badass *adult* woman who knows what she's doing.

DARA

Right. And what am I doing?

Dara lifts a thumbnail to her teeth - but Shae pulls it away without even looking.

DARA (CONT'D)

Please just tell me what to do. I don't wanna get yelled at again.

SHAE

(halting, not turning)

Wait. He *yelled* at you?

DARA

I just said that.

SHAE

No. You said he was weird about it.

(typing again with force)

That he made you feel like *you* were being weird. But you never said that he *yelled* at you...Dara...

Shae stabs Ctrl+S and swings to Dara. Gently:

SHAE (CONT'D)

...did he yell at you?

ZEKI (PRE-LAP)

I asked her to do her job.

ZEKI'S DESK - LATER

Shae patiently sits with the impatiently coding ZEKI (30s).

SHAE

Right. But the thing is, that's not *your* job. If you have concerns with an HR associate, you come to me.

ZEKI

I'm not concerned about your mini-me, Shae. I'm concerned about...*me*.

SHAE

Why? Ram said you're irreplaceable.

ZEKI

Everyone is replaceable. You know what we build here.

(beat, turning)

And I can't lose this job.

Shae follows his nervous eyes to a framed photo of his family in Turkey. She overdoes a sympathetic sigh.

SHAE

Listen, I get it--

ZEKI

No. You don't. You work here because you *can*. I work here because I'm *temporarily permitted*. If I don't get another H1-B...

SHAE

Zeki. If the company promised you a Green Card, they'll handle it.

ZEKI

But you basically *are* this company, Shae. Why can't you handle it?

SHAE

Because that's above my head.

She smirks. *For now*. Then struts off. Leaving Zeki confused.

COFFEE BAR - MINUTES LATER

Hunky barista KEVIN preps an iced latte for an incoming Shae.

SHAE

My angel. Can you actually make it hot for me today?

KEVIN

But you're already on fire.

She blushes and pulls out her phone, as he foams her milk.

SHAE

I didn't see you at the party.

KEVIN

Oh I thought that was for like,
actual employees.

SHAE

Kevin. You're part of the family.

Just then, Shae sees a beach pic on her phone. Same beach as Laura's instagram. But it's not Laura. It's a DAD with a teen girl - in a message chain with someone named NINA.

KEVIN

Is that your sister?

SHAE

Only half. But I guess everyone
prefers the new and improved model.
(under breath)
He really can't find another beach?

As she steams, he slides her a STEAMING LATTE under eye-line.

KEVIN

There's taro buns in the kitchen.
If you haven't had your yogurt yet.

SHAE

What would I do without you?

KEVIN

Spend less time in the office?

She SNORTS foam. *Funny*. Then she marches off with a smile...

...leaving Kevin rolling his eyes. He wasn't joking.

SHAE (PRE-LAP)

The true value of a company is its
people. And that's my job--

CONFERENCE ROOM - LATER

Shae recites her spiel as she places printed POWERPOINT DECKS
around a table. Muffins too.

SHAE (CONT'D)

--building a home for human capital
to flourish. And as Vice President--

DOOR OPENS for--

SHAE

Ram?

Ram collapses onto the sofa. Phone falls to the floor.

SHAE

What's going on? This is the most important meeting of my life. Are you seriously hungover right now?

RAM

Shae. It's a bloodbath.

SHAE

Well then stop doing coke with Grady! Just take some advil or something before Gus gets here.

RAM

Gus is never coming back here. As of today, he's *persona non grata*.

SHAE

Is that in Italy?
(under breath)
Is everyone at the beach?

Shae grabs a muffin for a nervous bite--

RAM

No. Shae. I mean: Gus is dead--

--SPRAYS MUFFIN before Ram can finish--

RAM (CONT'D)

--to us. Olympus Capital *terminated* him last night.

SHAE

What. They can't do that.

RAM

They own 100% of our equity now.
They can do whatever they want.

Finally, Shae picks up Ram's phone. NEWS ARTICLE on screen:

BLOODBATH! TECH MARKET MELTS DOWN, FIRMS SCRAMBLE TO SURVIVE

RAM (CONT'D)

And they want to restructure.
As of this morning, the firm's controlling shares have been transferred to some special purpose LLC to oversee the transition.

DING!

SHAE
What. Who's Elsie?

COLD AIR WHOOSHES inside as Ram cracks the door to see:

ELLSIE

gliding off the elevator with icy efficiency. Ageless in a tailored suit, she assesses her new domain. Then enters Gus's office like a parasite infecting its host.

Ram scurries over to meet his new boss...

...leaving Shae alone with her "Shae Value" deck. Fuck.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae rushes in. Stashes her personal items (clothes, sheets, toiletries) in the closet. Then finds her Shae Value deck. She RIPS it in half. Then again. Again. Again.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - LATER

Shae pretends to work. But watches Ellsie - in her new office - issue Ram instructions while purging Gus's personal items.

DARA (O.S.)
Shae. Something's wrong.

Dara rolls her chair up. Eyes wide with panic.

SHAE
What? Nothing's wrong.

DARA
But Grady says we're getting gutted.

SHAE
Dara, please. Grady's a clinical moron. We only hired him because of his dad's hedge fund.

Sales guy GRADY (fleece vest, beautiful hair) leans over.

GRADY
And who do you think told me, Shae?
(reading text on phone)
He said we're "fat on the belly and the butcher's on the way".

Shae turns to him with sympathy: *he texted you that?*

Dara's eyes well up. Shae wraps her up like a camp counselor.

SHAE

Relax. Ram can handle this.

Ram emerges. Followed by his handler, Ellsie.

RAM

Morning everyone. Um. I know things seem...*frantic* recently. But we have some exciting updates for you about the future of this company--

ELLSIE

This company is insolvent.

(beat)

I will be salvaging any valuable assets prior to liquidation. Carry on your assigned tasks as normal.

Everyone looks at Shae. Dara pulls at her sweater like a kid in the supermarket: *say something!*

SHAE

But I thought we were doing well.

ELLSIE

At what?

(off Shae's glitch)

What do you do?

SHAE

Oh. We're a global provider of--

ELLSIE

No. What does this company do?

Shae stammers. Ellsie scans the crowd for another answer...

ZEKI

We build and sell automated B2C engagement software. Like chatbots. Customer service phone trees.

Ellsie assesses him. Then points to Gus's old office. Zeki quickly complies. Ellsie turns to follow him, but--

SHAE

But we're more than that. We have a really special culture here.

ELLSIE

Your culture is a luxury. And a relic of low interest rates.

SHAE
Well I'm sorry but--

ELLSIE
Why? Did you do something wrong?

SHAE
No, it's just - if you destroy the culture, all the best people will leave. It'll be a bloodbath.

ELLSIE
(processing, then)
Okay. I appreciate the insight.

Ellsie proceeds to her new office to meet Zeki.

Shae circles around to see: everyone smiling. It's a win!

A WEEK LATER

Shae circles around to see: an emptying office. It's a--

RAM (O.S.)
--bloodbath.

Ram slumps in a chair. Grady and the Jamies at nearby desks.

SHAE
Relax. She hasn't fired anyone yet.

JAMIE 1
She's smoking us out. Everyone who can get another job is leaving.

SHAE
(noticing Dara listening)
Great. So she needs us.

JAMIE 2
She's here to gut us. We need her.

GRADY
I don't need her.

SHAE
Grady. You have a DUI.

GRADY
CUI. And Jamie's thing is worse!

JAMIE 1
You told him?

JAMIE 2
You told him?

SHAE
Jamies, please! What can we do?

JAMIE 1
Quit before it's too late?

JAMIE 2
No. If we get fired, we can get
severance *and* unemployment.

Dara chomps her nail and runs off. Shae chases after.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - CONTINUOUS

Shae finds Dara stepping up on a MAINTENANCE LADDER.

SHAE
Where do you think you're going?

Dara looks up - from the first floor, the ladder goes up forever...but not back down to ground level. She exhales and sinks down, against the ladder. Shae wraps her shivering body in a cardigan. Sits.

DARA
What am I gonna tell my family?

SHAE
They'll understand. It's not like
they replaced you with another
daughter or anything.

DARA
Shae. This isn't about you.

SHAE
Sorry, I mean: you have value.
Someone will see that.

DARA
That's easy for you to say. You're
already...*there*. And I'm what?
Going back to Michigan to be
another New York burnout?

Dara tries to bite a pinky - but Shae gently takes her hand.

SHAE
Dara. I will die before I let you
go back to Michigan.

DARA
Shae. *This isn't about you.*

INT. OFFICE - LATER

Shae marches to Gus's old office. Ram scrambling behind her.

RAM
--please don't. She's only keeping
me to keep things calm. And I can't
get fired. I have nowhere to go!

SHAE
I'm not scared of her.

RAM
Well maybe you should be.

~~GUS'S OFFICE~~ ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae surprises Ellsie at her desk. Ram at Shae's heels.

RAM
I told her not to--

ELLSIE
Leave.

Shae gulps and follows Ram out--

ELLSIE
Not you.

Both turn back. Ellsie nods to Ram, who gets it. Leaves.

SHAE
It's Elsie, right?

ELLSIE
There are two L's.

Ellsie sits at her computer. Shae notices a trashbag with Gus's stuff. And a POTTED PLANT with brown, crispy leaves.

SHAE
Sure. Anyway. I uh, wanted to see
if you wanted to get some coffee?
Kevin is...*amazing*.

ELLSIE
A Keurig can do his job.

SHAE
Right. Okay. Well, this is actually
what I wanted to talk about. You
have such a clear communication--

ELLSIE
This a problem?

SHAE
No, no. That's actually the good
part. And not really the point--

ELLSIE
Then why did you say it?

SHAE
To cushion the critical feedback.
(miming a sandwich)
It's uh, it's a compliment sandwich.

ELLSIE
It's a condescending waste of time.

SHAE
It's our culture. And I told you if
you destroy it, people will leave.

ELLSIE
And I told you I appreciated the
insight. Those voluntary departures
lowered our severance liabilities.

GASP. She is here to gut them. But it gets worse.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Yet liabilities remain.

Ellsie finally turns her full attention to Shae. Uh oh.

ELLSIE
Shae. What do you do?
(anticipating)
Not your title. When you are at
your desk, what do you actually do?

SHAE
Sorry, I--

ELLSIE
Stop apologizing and answer me.

SHAE
I do people stuff! Okay? I get them
to show up. I get them to *care*. And
that's irreplaceable. And it's why,
before you got here, they were gonna
promote me to Vice President!

Ellsie looks her up and down with utter pity.

ELLSIE

Shae. They were never going to make you a Vice President.

SHAE

What. I've given my life--

ELLSIE

Exactly. Why would they pay extra?

SHAE

You don't understand. I basically, like, *am* this company.

ELLSIE

No. You don't understand.

Ellsie backs the terrified Shae to the door...

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

You are rented labor trained to accept validation, frivolity, and a false sense of security in lieu of material compensation.

...until Shae is in the hall.

ELLSIE

I am the company now.

Ellsie SLAMS the door on her face. Then hears a SQUEAK.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NIGHT

SQUEAKING of Shae's mouse as she furiously pages through apartment listings. She changes the price filter. NO RESULTS.

The floor is silent. It's late. But Ellsie's still in her office, so Shae can't "go home" yet.

THUMP. Shae hears the sound coming from Ellsie's office.

THUMP. Shae approaches carefully. The blinds are drawn, but light bleeds through a crack. And now she hears:

THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS.

Shae leans in. Through the gap:

A SHADOW moving in rhythm. A BARE FOOT stomping on the ground repeatedly. It's fucking weird. THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS.

As Shae leans closer, the sounds halt and--

ELLSIE'S EYE fills the crack.

Shae JOLTS back. Spins around and races toward:

RAM'S OFFICE

and bolts inside. Closes the door. Catches her breath.

RAM (O.S.)
Are you okay?

Shae JUMPS. She didn't realize Ram was there.

SHAE
Yeah. She's just...doing something
in there.

She turns and sees Ram laying on the sofa. Looking pathetic.

SHAE
Are you okay?

RAM
Gus won't return my calls. Do you
think he hates me for staying?

SHAE
(sitting, sympathetic)
*Hate you? He's just in Bali or
whatever. But you know he loves
you. I mean, Ram, he made you COO.*

RAM
Please. You know I only got the job
because Doug got caught on that
website, and I...I had just *been*
here forever. I never knew what I
was doing. I'm an imposter.
(jumping her protest)
*It's okay. That's my thing. I'm
good at being seen as good. But
that only works in a bull market.
And now, well...the bear is here.*

SHAE
Don't call her that. That's sexist.

RAM
The bear market, Shae. No one's
buying my act in a downturn. But
you, you can still get out of here.

Shae shakes her head, on the verge of tears.

RAM

You have to. At least interview--

SHAE

I did! I applied to 17 companies. I emailed every HR person I know. 4 ignored me. 13 bounced back.

RAM

Because you had the wrong emails?

SHAE

Because they got fired, Ram! No one wants them. No one wants *me*. I thought this was all I knew how to do. But apparently I'm not even good at it. Just good at *seeming good*--
(hearing it now)
Oh my god. Ram. I'm the imposter.

Ram waves his hands: no!

SHAE

Seriously think about it. We played one drunk game of laser tag like six years ago. Then things went well and you gave me all this credit because you *liked* me. Then once you became my mentor or whatever, you *had* to pretend I was good. Because if I wasn't, what would it say about you?

RAM

Jesus, Shae. That's sick.

SHAE

It's true! And now I'm locked in. I gave my whole life to advance here. And all the sudden, here is over and I can never get *there*?

Ram looks around. Where?

MEDITATION ROOM - MINUTES LATER

Shae dribbles in. Head down like charlie brown. Kills the lights. Flops onto the made-up sofa.

In the darkness, she whimpers into the pillow.

ELLSIE (O.S.)

So. This really is your home.

LIGHTS ON. Ellsie sits calmly in the corner.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

I've never seen someone actually
bring their *whole self* to work.

SHAE

It's temporary. The market is just
crazy. And my roommate moved out--
(off Ellsie's blank stare)
And technically there's no rule
against it. And I like it here. I
have everything I need. For free.

ELLSIE

Nothing is free.

SHAE

Sure. I guess like, *metaphorically*.

ELLSIE

I don't use metaphors on company
time. Food, facilities, freezing
your eggs. The perks are here to
keep you here. And here you are.

SHAE

And? Why are you here?

ELLSIE

My job is to invest in distressed
assets, strip their liabilities,
and maximize their value.

Shae deflates onto a yoga ball, which deflates.

SHAE

I get it. I'm the liability.

ELLSIE

No, Shae. You're just distressed.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - MINUTES LATER

In pajamas, Shae watches Ellsie use gardening scissors to
SNIP dead leaves off the plant. She kept it. Nice.

ELLSIE

Gus was a fine engineer, but he
failed to deliver the product he
promised. Instead wasting resources
on diversions like...email chains.
Birthday cake. Meetings.

SHAE

We're having brainstorming sessions
on how to trim back on those.

ELLSIE

We have to trim *everything* if this
firm is going to survive, Shae.

SNIP. Ellsie looks up at an ORG CHART on the wall. A massive
web of faces, names, and titles. SNIP.

ELLSIE

It will be a difficult transition.
That's why I'm retaining Ram as
Interim CEO. But I still need an
additional resource to help
acclimate the headcount to our new
economic reality. Someone with a
bit of...*human touch*.

Shae quietly GASPS. But doesn't respond. Ellsie sits.

ELLSIE

Shae. I'm expressing a need for
your services. This is the part
when you tell me what you want.

SHAE

Well maybe I can review the details
first and then we can circle back?

ELLSIE

There is no circle. Just a line
from your supply to my demand.
So, show me the line.

SHAE

Vice President.

Ellsie's surprised at the quick response. But squints. *Why?*

SHAE

Because that's how I get there.

Ellsie looks around. *Where?*

SHAE

There. Where I've made it. Where I
have security. Where I can just...*go*
to the beach without worrying about
falling behind, or being replaced.

ELLSIE

Employees can always be replaced.

SHAE
Aren't you an Olympus employee?

ELLSIE
The Partners at Olympus are both my
shareholders and clients. But I
remain an independent entity. As I
told you before:
(beat)
I am the company.

Oh. Shae realizes that was never a metaphor.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
I know it pains everyone to admit,
but Mitt Romney was right.

Ellsie leans in, practically purring.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
About corporations being people.
(savoring the concept)
We're all just *independent agents*
transacting value.
(eyes flashing)
And Shae, I see your value.

GASP. It's everything Shae's ever wanted to hear.

ELLSIE
In fact, I'd like to discuss an
investment opportunity.

SHAE
An investment in what?

ELLSIE
You.

Ellsie slides over an EQUITY AGREEMENT. Shae blinks.

ELLSIE
My Analyst can help with the details.

Ellsie rises and opens a closet door.

CLOSET - MOMENTS LATER

Shae sits with a red-eyed, neck-tatted ANALYST (late 20s),
churning out spreadsheets. Monitors flashing manically.

SHAE
Is this a bad time?

ANALYST

Market's in a death spiral. Firms
are being stripped for parts.

(smile)

No better time for private equity.

He shakes a container with a MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

ANALYST

Meal replacement? Their Russian
portfolio company makes it.

SHAE

I'm okay. Is that like Soylent?

ANALYST

Not according to the FDA.

He scoops GREEN POWDER into water. Stirs. Sips.

ANALYST

So. She's gonna invest in you.

SHAE

Maybe. Unless it's a bad idea?

ANALYST

It's a great idea. As long as you
know what you're doing.

SHAE

Totally. And what am I doing?

ANALYST

Selling shares in yourself. So you
get cash now. And she gets a stake
in your future value. You
understand how equity works?

SHAE

That's like stock, right?

He nods.

SHAE

Then no.

ANALYST

Okay. Let's start with the basics.

He jumps to his feet.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

Finance...is like time travel.

He waits for this to land. It doesn't.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

Think about your student loans. You borrow money from the future to pay for school in the present. But you have to pay it back no matter what. So the lender doesn't care about you beyond your ability to pay.

SHAE

They're not *invested* in me.

ANALYST

Bingo. But with equity, you don't pay anything back. Your shares rise in value as you rise in value. So development and growth are in your investor's best interest. Got it?

SHAE

For sure. 100%. It's just that, it doesn't really make any sense.

ANALYST

That's the beauty of finance, Shae. It doesn't need to make *sense*.
(eyes twinkling)
It just needs to make *money*. And you just need to create value.

SHAE

Don't I have value...*inside me*?

ANALYST

I guess. But she doesn't care what you are. What matters is what you do. Exploit underutilized resources. And find any way possible to grow assets or cut liabilities. It's a simple formula.

He scribbles on a pad: EQUITY = ASSETS - LIABILITIES.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

That's your valuation. Benchmarked against expectation of course.

SHAE

But how does she set expectations? We can't see the future.

ANALYST

But we *can* simulate it in a model.

SHAE
In our minds?

ANALYST
In Excel.

He pops open some spreadsheets. She's overwhelmed.
He shakes the container of GREEN POWDER. It helps!

CUT TO:

30-50 MINUTES LATER

Shae's bopping around on her toes. Really getting it now.

SHAE
Finance is like time travel!

Analyst pumps his fist. Yeah!

SHAE
It doesn't need to make sense.

Analyst gives PRAYER HANDS and BOWS – preach!

SHAE (CONT'D)
I can calculate my present value by
estimating my assets, liabilities,
and future growth expectations!

Shae takes a big gulp of green drink.

ANALYST
So. Shae. How much are you worth?

He pulls up a spreadsheet: SHAE-VALUE.xlsx.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NEXT MORNING

The SHAE-VALUE excel sheet on her monitor.

Shae's alone. Clearly up all night. Green still on her lips.

She peeks at an old copy of her printed SHAE-VALUE deck.
Compared to the new excel sheet, it looks so quaint.

She tosses it in the trash.

Then turns to her WHITE BOARD. Replaces Q1: LEAN IN with-

Q2: LEAN OPERATIONS

The marker SQUEAKS.

INT. OFFICE - BIKE ROOM - THAT MORNING

SQUEAKING on the SPINNING WHEEL of the EXERCISE BIKE.

Shae's pumping away in a room full of bikes. But she's alone, sipping her green drink. She pushes. Spinning the wheel faster and faster with a HISS--

PRE-LAP: HISS. THUMP. HISS. THUMP--

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

THUMP as Ellsie pivots, planting her bare foot.

HISS as she exhales and STRIKES with her opposite fist. She's doing some kickboxing-style routine. It's rhythmic. And disciplined. And weird.

THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS--

SERVER ROOM

HISS of servers in long rows...

...leading to a desk in front of a WALL OF MONITORS...

...where Zeki codes. Locked in. Beside him, a large container of green powder with the MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

Fingers TAP faster.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - A LITTLE LATER

Shae TAPS open LinkedIn on her phone. Checks her new title: Vice President of People Operations.

Clicks SHARE. But with who? She opens messages with DAD.

But it's just pics of fucking Nina. And months of "coming home anytime soon?" and "sorry - crazy busy at work".

COFFEE BAR - SHORTLY AFTER

Kevin presents Shae an exquisite latte prepared. S on top in foam. She blushes, sips softly. Then notices a light on in:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

and finds Ellsie SNIPPING dead leaves from Gus's plant. It's still brown, but coming back to life. Nice!

SHAE

Oh. I didn't realize you were here.

ELLSIE

I was just checking on Francis.

SHAE

Francis, nice. So is he like your--

ELLSIE

I need cuts to recurring expenses.

SHAE

Expenses. Sure. For example...

ELLSIE

For example: *lunch*.

SHAE

That...might be tricky for morale.

ELLSIE

Morale is not my concern.

SHAE

But it's mine. And data clearly show correlation with performance. Plus, it costs us nothing to be attentive to the emotional context.

Ellsie reviews her. Shae's finally speaking her language.

ELLSIE

Fine. Attend to it.

(as Shae takes the win)

But there will be no lunch.

GRADY (PRE-LAP)

So we just *pay* for it ourselves?

KITCHEN - LUNCHTIME

Dara, Grady, and the Jamies unpack salads.

SHAE

We were always paying, Grady. The lunch money came out of the employee discretionary budget.

SHAE (CONT'D)
(sipping green drink)
Money that *could've* gone to you.

JAMIE 1
Where's it going now?

SHAЕ
The balance sheet. To pay for us.

DARA
That doesn't make any sense.

SHA3
If it's saving our jobs, does it
really need to make sense?

Yes. JAMIE 1 Yes. JAMIE 2

Dara raises her fingernail to teeth. Shae pulls it away.

SHAE

I told you everything is fine. Why are you so worried?

(off Dara's shrug)

Then stop worrying. I'm not letting anyone get fired. She *invested* in me to manage people stuff. I just need to prove my value first. You know, show her what she paid for.

Grady's face pinches. Ew.

SHAE (CONT'D)
I mean my human touch.

Ew. JAMIE 1 Ew. JAMIE 2

SHAEE

What I'm doing is not gross! It's *innovative*. And gives me influence. Which we all need, unless we want to end up like Gus.

Everyone exchanges glances. She's right.

RAM (PRE-LAP)
Gus.

RAM'S OFFICE - SAME

Ram leaves Gus a voicemail.

RAM

Hey. It's me again. Guess you're not using your phone in Bali or whatever. But I just really need to talk to you. I'm a little worried--

SQUEAK! A mouse races past Ram's feet.

MAIN FLOOR - MOMENTS LATER

Ram scrambles out and BUMPS into Shae, spilling green juice.

What the hell Ram!?

RAM

Sorry! There was a--

Just then a MOUSE races over Shae's feet and into the:

SERVER ROOM

where Shae and Ram chase it inside.

BUZZ! They look around. Then down. The mouse!

Electrocuted by some homemade mouse trap. It's horrifying.

ZEKI (O.S.)

Shae? What are you doing?

SHAE

What are you doing?

Zeki looks over from his desk. Sipping green drink.

ZEKI

Oh. They love the heat in here. And the old traps suck. I made these from laptop batteries.

(proud, then turning back)

But why am I explaining myself?
I don't answer to either of you.

RAM

You don't?

SHAE

Listen, I know you're still upset about the Green Card thing--

RAM

You promised him a Green Card?

ZEKI

This isn't about you, Shae. You
just *really* can't be here. Really.

Then Shae notices: Ram staring at a monitor. It's...

RAM

GUS?

Gus. He's been on video conference this whole time.

RAM (CONT'D)

What the hell are you doing here? I
thought you were in Bali.

ZEKI

He *is* in Bali. And the audio isn't
working right now. I'm just pulling
some of his old code.

SHAE

So he's working remotely?

ZEKI

It's just for the new product.

RAM

What new product?

SHAE

What new product?

ELLSIE (O.S.)

The product is in stealth mode.

ELLSIE appears behind them. AH!

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

Intellectual property is at high
risk with such a...fluid personnel
situation in the office.

RAM

But I'm supposed to be the CEO.

ELLSIE

Interim CEO. Do you know what
interim means, Ramesh? It means:
for now. And for now, you have one
function: *simulating continuity*.
Shae will ensure you do this.

RAM

So she's, what, my boss?

SHAE

Of course not.

ELLSIE

Yes.

Shae slowly turns to a stunned Ram with a grin.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Shae. With me.

HALLWAY

Shae wheezes as she catches up to Ellsie.

ELLSIE
Leave Zeki alone. And keep everyone
out of that server room. What is
the status of recurring expenses?

SHAE
Um, lunch is done. And I canceled
the cleaning contracts. I figured
we can tidy up after ourselves.

Ellsie stops at a bathroom. Turns. Stares. It's weird.

SHAE
What's...happening right now?

ELLSIE
I'm pleased. And acknowledging you,
as I've seen you do with others.

SHAE
But you're not smiling.

ELLSIE
I'm very busy.

Shae notices a workout bag in Ellsie's hands.

SHAE
Oh are you about to work out? I
thought I saw you like kickboxing--

ELLSIE
Just go do your job, Shae. Focus on
your circle of competencies.

SHAE
...managing resources for humans?

ELLSIE
The humans are the resources. And
there are too many. Deal with them.

Ellsie turns, opens the bathroom door. Shae exhales. *I guess this is the job.*

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Starting with Dara.

The door closes on Shae's face.

PRE-LAP: CRYING

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - LATER

Dara's CRYING echoes across the main floor. Grady exchanges a look with the Jamies. *What's going on?*

MEETING ROOM

Dara sniffles. Shae's lap is covered in tissues.

DARA
But you said everything is fine. I
mean, she's giving you a bonus.

SHAE
It's not a bonus. It's equity.
She's investing in my future value.

DARA
But what about *our* value?

Shae thinks. Then sees Team Members watching from outside.
Their distressed faces.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - NEXT DAY

Those same distressed faces. On a printed slide deck. Titled:

HUMAN CAPITAL: INVESTING IN PEOPLE

ELLSIE (O.S.)
But I don't want them.

Ellsie looks across at Shae and the Analyst. They've been up all night. Red eyes. Green lips.

SHAE
No one does. That's the point.
They're distressed assets. And you--

ELLSIE
I know what I do, Shae.

SHAE

Then it would be irresponsible not to at least review the opportunity.

ANALYST

Check the ROI projections on 12.

Ellsie reluctantly flips to real data. Hm. Peeks at Analyst.

ELLSIE

You taught her this?

SHAE

You did. I've been listening to everything you said since you got here. And they're just *independent agents transacting value*. And we can get more out of them than anyone else. Because we know their value. As people. We know the value that they have *inside them*.

Ellsie's eyes flicker. Shae betrays a tiny smirk.

ELLSIE

(closing deck)

Olympus owns this office. And they want it vacated by Q4.

SHAE

Then we'll get a new office.

ELLSIE

No.

Shae sinks. But Ellsie rises. Takes the deck.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

We don't need one.

RAM (PRE-LAP)

Remote Only?

RAM'S OFFICE - LATER

Shae stands as she briefs Ram on the sofa.

SHAE

This is how we can all stay.

RAM

But we're *not* staying. Was this Gus's idea?

SHAE
...he was part of the decision.

Ram scoffs. He knew it.

SHAE (CONT'D)
I mean he's already proven a remote
model can work. Now Zeki can scale
that across the team.

RAM
The team is going to freak out.

MAIN FLOOR

The team is celebrating when Shae comes out. After a bit, the Partner and his large Consultant emerge from Ellsie's office.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae finds Ellsie watching everyone scatter from her window.

ELLSIE
Olympus is enthused. They agreed to
lend their Consultant and equipment
to expedite the transitions.

SHAE
What kind of equipment?

ELLSIE
Just focus on yourself, Shae. The
burden will be substantial. Do you
have a proper training regimen?

Shae looks down at Ellsie's workout pants. The workout bag.

SHAE
Oh my god. You want to work out
together.

ELLSIE
Don't make a scene.

But Shae can't help herself. She's beaming.

SHAE
You care about me.

ELLSIE
I have a fiduciary obligation to
improve your physical wellbeing.

SHAE
That's the nicest thing anyone's
ever said to me.

ELLSIE
Just get changed.

YOGA ROOM - LATER

Ellsie reviews Shae's gym shorts and company T-shirt.

ELLSIE
This is too flabby.

SHAE
That's why I'm here.

ELLSIE
I mean the excess material leaves
you exposed. Try to strike me.

Ellsie waves her on. Shae winds up and PUNCHES--

Ellsie DUCKS left, THUMPS her foot behind Shae, yanks her
shirt then throws her.

Shae SMACKS her elbow on the way down. Eyes fill with tears.

ELLSIE
Stop crying.

SHAE
But it hurts.

ELLSIE
Feeling is a message, Shae. You can
ignore it. Like email. Now. Focus
on timing.

Shae stumbles to her feet. Ellsie waves her to attack. Shae
charges at Ellsie--

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Capture momentum.

Ellsie sidesteps with a THUMP.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
And impact with leverage.

Ellsie exhales HISS as she POPS Shae behind the knee, who
buckles to the ground. Shae sucks down the tears, and rises
off the floor on her own. LFG.

TRAINING MONTAGE

Over the course of a few weeks, Ellsie trains Shae in the yoga room, the Analyst trains her in his closet, and Shae signs up assets to the portfolio.

THUMP/HISS keeps rhythm as we cycle around the office:

- SHAE uncaps a green marker. Reviews faces on the ORG CHART.

SHAE (V.O.)
She sees your long-term value.

- SHAE pitches the team, deck in hand: INVESTING IN YOU.

SHAE (CONT'D)
We just have to prove her right.

- ZEKI sips green drink, codes with Gus (on his monitor).

ANALYST (V.O.)
Find the underutilized resources.

- THE JAMIES sign their contracts.

ELLSIE (V.O.)
Exploit every opportunity.

- WEBCAM LIGHTS turn GREEN on laptops around the office.

ANALYST (V.O.)
Higher risk means higher rewards.

- FACES APPEAR from those webcams on Zeki's WALL OF MONITORS.

ELLSIE (V.O.)
Past performance does not guarantee
future results.

- RAM checks his texts to GUS - all green, unread. His contract on his desk, still unsigned.

ANALYST (V.O.)
Timing.

- GRADY sips some green drink. Signs the contract.

ELLSIE (V.O.)
Momentum.

- ORG CHART has faces circled in green. Except Dara and Ram.

SHAE (PRE-LAP)
Leverage.

END MONTAGE AT DARA'S DESK

Dara looks down at her unsigned contract, next to Shae.

SHAE (CONT'D)

This is the time, right now. We'll never get a better deal.

DARA

But I still don't understand why they even want me. Aren't I like the least valuable person here?

SHAE

It doesn't matter what you are, Dara. It only matters what you do.

DARA

But I don't know what to do.

Dara lifts a fingernail to her teeth--

SHAE

That's why you have me.

Shae intercepts her fingers. Hands her a pen. Dara signs.

DARA

Is that everyone?

Shae sighs. No.

RAM'S OFFICE - LATER

Ram watches skeptically as Shae heads to the coffee bar.

COFFEE BAR - MOMENTS LATER

Kevin hands Shae a mug of boiling tea.

KEVIN

Just be careful, that's--

Absentminded, she takes a HUGE GULP of the boiling tea.

KEVIN

--scalding hot. Are you okay?

Shae's staring at Ram's office, where he's hiding inside.

SHAE

Me? I'm not the one being a baby.

KEVIN

He's just scared. Going remote is a big deal for some people.

She turns back. Her cheeks are flat. Eyes bright, greenish. And she realizes she's been neglecting the *emotional context*.

SHAE

Oh my god. I should have told you: she agreed to keep you until Q4.

KEVIN

Thanks, Shae. But it's fine. I'm a contractor. That's the job.

SHAE

But what will I do without you?

KEVIN

Spend less time in the office.

She chuckles. But he's dead serious.

SHAE

Sorry. I thought that was a joke.

KEVIN

Why would I joke about that?

SHAE

Because we're friends. I mean, you know what time I eat my yogurt.

KEVIN

Shae. That's the job.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - A LITTLE LATER

Shae marches in, surprising Ellsie.

SHAE

We can get a Keurig.

ELLSIE

But I agreed to pay for the Kevin.

Shae just marches right off. Ellsie scowls...then turns her ire to the window...the coffee bar.

INT. OFFICE - COFFEE BAR - NIGHT

Ellsie approaches Kevin as he cleans up.

ELLSIE
Leaving early?

KEVIN
Shae just fired me.

ELLSIE
That is good to hear. But you are
still contracted for another hour.

KEVIN
Just tell me what you want.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
You observe behavior, when you
service the salaried staff. I want
your honest assessment of Shae.

KEVIN
Honestly?

SHAE

listens from around the corner, leaks out a little smile...

KEVIN (O.S.)(CONT'D)
She's unlike anyone I've ever met.
Just completely...delusional.

...which falls right to the floor.

COFFEE BAR

Ellsie notices Shae spying. But Shae quickly vanishes.

KEVIN (CONT'D)
I mean, she basically lives here.
And I think she thinks that's a
good thing? It's kind of pathetic.
(unsure whether to
continue)
But I guess she's good with people.
And she'll do anything for
validation. If that's helpful.

Ellsie nods: *it is*. Kevin's not sure if this is over. After a
bit, he points to the espresso machine.

KEVIN
If you're selling this, can I have
the backup espresso beans in the
freezer? They don't work for drip.

ELLSIE
Wash the dishes. Pack the machine.
And then you may have your beans.

PRE-LAP: DING!

BASEMENT - AN HOUR LATER

Kevin steps off the elevator and heads for the back exit. But first, he stops at the:

FREEZER

COLD HITS. It's dark. He can't find the light.

PHONE FLASHLIGHT ON. Sweeps the shelves until he finds--

ESPRESSO BEANS. He reaches for the bag but KNOCKS it over.

BEANS SPRAY all over the floor.

He crouches to clean up the beans. CREAK. He looks up at the doorway and sees:

ELLSIE!

THE DOOR CLOSES.

Kevin runs toward the door. Wait!

Grabs the handle. But it's locked. He BANGS!

BASEMENT HALLWAY

BANG BANG BANG from inside the freezer fades as...

Ellsie calmly walks back to the elevator.

BANGING becomes DRIBBLING (PRE-LAP)--

INT. OFFICE - COFFEE BAR - NEXT DAY

Shae finds a KEURIG dribbling coffee into a mug for Ellsie.

SHAE
I see Kevin's been optimized for
his core competencies.

ELLSIE
Is that a joke?

Shae can't read the tone. She nods, awkwardly.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
It's very amusing. I'll reflect on it in my personal time. Speaking of which, we should discuss your living situation.

SHAE
Right. I get it. If we're going to be working from home, I should probably, you know, *get a home*.

ELLSIE
You already have one.

She holds the moment. It's sweet, but Shae's not following.

SHAE
Is that a metaphor?

ELLSIE
Call it a bonus.

Ellsie sets down housekeys on the bar.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
The building is in our portfolio.

RAM'S OFFICE - SAME

Ram watches Shae smile at Ellsie. When Ellsie walks off, Shae turns to Ram. Eye contact. Her smile disappears.

DING-A-LING-A-LING

Ram finds his RINGING laptop. Opens it, revealing:

GUS on video call. Tan. Shell necklace. Tropical background.

RAM
Gus? I've been calling you.

GUS (REMOTE)
Sorry, man. The service here sucks. And I've been so busy with work.

RAM
Busy sending us home.

GUS (REMOTE)
Ram. Be real. They never planned to keep any of us. This is a win.

RAM
Really? So you're like, okay?

GUS (REMOTE)
I'm better than okay. This is
literally the best version of
myself I've ever been.

Ram looks down at his contract.

SERVER ROOM - SAME

On the monitor, Zeki watches Gus's video chat with Ram. After a minute, Ram signs his contract.

Ellsie, behind Zeki, dials a number. Walks out.

Zeki scoops some green powder from the MOUSE DOCTOR container into his water. Then leans forward to get back into his code.

PRE-LAP: SQUEAKING

BASEMENT - LATER

The Consultant pushes a massive crate down the the hallway...
...toward a WHITE ROOM. On the side: the MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. SHAE'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

ELEVATOR OPENS right into Shae's new place. Dara, Grady, and the Jamies step toward the floor-to-ceiling windows.

GRADY
Whoah. This is it?

SHAE
This is it.

Dara slumps onto an unpacked BOX. The place is unfurnished.

DARA
I can't believe this is really it.
I don't want to be apart.

SHAE
Hey. We'll still be together every
day. Just remotely. Come on, we're
supposed to be celebrating.

GRADY
We're supposed to be getting drunk.

PRE-LAP: POP

A LITTLE LATER

Grady's pouring prosecco in plastic cups. Meanwhile, Shae finds Dara lingering by the window.

SHAE
I haven't told anyone yet. But
we're gonna have a party on our
last day before Q4. I'm thinking we
can do a luau.

DARA
(excited, then nervous)
You're not inviting those Olympus
guys right?

SHAE
Dara. They're our investors. What
are you so worried about?

Dara shrugs and brings her fingers to her teeth--

SHAE
Then stop worrying.

Shae SLAPS Dara's hand away.

PRE-LAP: DING!

LATER

The elevator arrives. Shae hugs everyone as they get on.

DOORS CLOSE on their faces. Shae exhales. Alone for the first time all night. She drifts to the window. The city below.

In the GLASS: her reflection. Behind her, the lingering shapes of Dara, the Jamies, Grady. Laughing.

She smiles at them. The reflection settles. Just her now. Alone in the frame. She smiles wider. She has everything.

BUZZ. She finds her phone. A text from Nina. Uch.

She tosses it. Looks around. Remembers she has no bed.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. OFFICE - THAT NIGHT

Shae returns to the office. It's empty. Except a light on in:

RAM'S OFFICE

where Shae finds Ram laying on his sofa.

SHAE

Why are you still here?

Ram slumps his shoulders. Shae takes a seat.

SHAE (CONT'D)

This attitude is bad for morale.

He scoffs and turns away from her.

SHAE (CONT'D)

I know you're mad at me but--

RAM

This isn't about you, Shae--

SHAE

Well I know Gus is acting weird--

RAM

It's not about Gus either.

SHAE

Then what is it about?

RAM

Us. It's about us. We're being torn apart. And you don't even care.

(beat)

You're becoming...like her.

SHAE

Is that supposed to be a bad thing?

RAM

Shae. She's basically a robot.

SHAE

That's sexist. If a man acted like that, you'd think he was some devoted genius or something.

RAM

I mean it. She has no feelings. Or any life outside this office.

SHAE

That's not true. She actually has a boyfriend. Named Francis. It's you who doesn't have a life.

RAM

I know. And I don't want you to make the same mistakes as me. Don't have nowhere else to go.

SHAE

I just got a new apartment.

RAM

Grady said you didn't even unpack. I know you're still sleeping here.

Shae's jaw locks into place. *Still?* He knew?

RAM (CONT'D)

I'm not judging you. I'm just worried, if she finds out--

And then he sees it in her eyes. Ellsie knows. A quiet beat.

SHAE

She trusts me, Ram. She saw my value when no one else did.

RAM

I get it. And I'm so sor--

SHAE

Stop. Don't do that. I know how hard you fought for my promotion.

But she sees something in his eyes. Guilt? Oh no.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Right?

RAM

Shae. I'm so sorry--

SHAE

Stop apologizing and tell me the tr--

RAM

The truth is I'm sorry. I wanted you to have it. *Obviously*. But things were crazy. I couldn't bring it up with Gus. And you, you were our rock. I knew you'd stay. So I guess, I guess we didn't have to.

This seeps deep into Shae's bones: Ellsie was right.

RAM (CONT'D)

But now, as your friend--

SHAE

We're not friends, Ram. You were my boss. And now I'm yours. And from here, I can see you were right the whole time. You are an imposter.

(rising for door)

And you're transitioning tonight.

RAM

But you said I had until Q4--

SHAE

It sends a stronger message to the team to start with the CEO. Go see the Consultant before he leaves.

RAM

No. Please. Something's wrong--

SHAE

He's just going to get your hardware sorted for remote work.

RAM

--with her. She scares me.

SHAE

You're just threatened by a woman who doesn't buy your bullshit.

RAM

I'm not threatened by you.

SHAE

Well maybe you should be.

MAIN FLOOR

Shae SLAMS the door behind her. Then marches off, past the:

SERVER ROOM

where Zeki's passed out at his desk. Green on lips.

Beside him, the MOUSE DOCTOR container RATTLES...

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. SHAE'S APARTMENT - A LITTLE LATER

Shae strolls back in. Covered in boxes. Checks a text from NINA: *"Hey. My mom asked if ur coming home for dads bday?"*.

She dismisses it. Thinks. Then opens again, responds: *"Hey. Have a huge work thing and I'm moving into my new place. But tell him I'll try to call."* Thinks. Adds *"XOXO"*.

Then grabs a boxcutter. Starts unpacking her new life.

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT HALLWAY - SAME

DING!

Ram steps off the elevator and sees the Consultant waiting outside the white room.

CHEERY MUSIC playing inside.

INTERCUT:**- SHAE'S APARTMENT**

CHEERY MUSIC echoes off empty walls from Shae's phone.

She slices boxes with the boxcutter.

MUSIC STOPS. Phone's dead. As she hunts for a charger, she KNOCKS the boxcutter to the floor with a CLACK.

- SERVER ROOM

CLACK goes the container as it FALLS OVER onto Zeki's desk.

A MOUSE scurries out...covered in green powder...right past Zeki's pale, sleeping face. He doesn't wake up.

- WHITE ROOM

Ram follows the Consultant into the cheery music. Sees the MACHINE. Like a tanning bed.

The Consultant opens it. Gestures for Ram to get inside.

Ram turns to the door, but the Consultant snaps it shut.

PRE-LAP: BUZZING

- SERVER ROOM

BUZZING finally wakes Zeki.

He drops to his knees, follows a trail of green powder...

...to an electric mouse trap...

...and a MOUSE being electrocuted. Licking green powder off itself. Undisturbed.

Zeki turns to the MOUSE DOCTOR logo on the meal replacement container. His half-empty glass. He touches his lips...

...leaving his fingers green.

He HURLS the glass against the wall.

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

Shae finishes her green drink as she returns with a charger. STEPS on the boxcutter--

SLICES the bottom of her foot. Doesn't notice.

But does notice the shimmer of her floor-to-ceiling windows. She steps to the gorgeous view...

- SERVER ROOM

Thick green liquid drips down the wall...

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

...blood trails from Shae's foot on her way to the window.

In the reflection: her gleaming SMILE.

RAM (PRE-LAP)

Shae.

- WHITE ROOM

The machine THUMPS and HISSES.

- SERVER ROOM

On the monitor behind Zeki: Ram's face flickers to life.

RAM (PRE-LAP)

Something's wrong--

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - WEEKS LATER

Jamie 1 rolls a CAKE on a cart past Shae's desk. Drawn in icing: an ORG CHART. But the smiling faces are in laptop monitors. Shae and Ellsie at the top. It reads:

Q3: DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

Shae video chats with Ram on her laptop.

RAM (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
--with direct deposits. There's an
issue with the payments.

SHAE
Just come in. Dara will help you.

RAM (REMOTE)
I can't come to the office.

SHAE
(deep breath)
Listen. I know we haven't talked
since you transitioned and you're
mad at me or whatever. But you're
still technically CEO. And--
(big exhale)
You should be here for the party.

RAM (REMOTE)
I'm sorry. I just can't.

SHAE
Can't or won't?

Ram processes.

RAM (REMOTE)
Both.

SHAE
But you love silent discos.
Remember in Nashville?

RAM (REMOTE)
It sounds fun, Shae. Be sure to
enjoy a single serving of alcohol
in a well lit space on my behalf.

SHAE
What the hell is wrong with you?

RAM (REMOTE)
Nothing. This is literally the best
version of myself I've ever been.

SHAE
Are you mocking me?

Ram doesn't respond.

Shae SLAMS her laptop shut, revealing--

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Is there a problem with Ram?

ELLSIE incoming.

SHAE
Where do I even start? He's so
immature. I can't believe I ever
looked up to him.

ELLSIE
Choose your mentors wisely.

SHAE
Right. Just imagine where I'd be if
I had an *Elsie* this whole time.

Shae waits for validation...

ELLSIE
There are two L's, Shae.
(hand on shoulder)
And you have one now.

...validation achieved.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Come on, Shae.
(checking watch)
It's time to party.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - A FEW MINUTES LATER

LIGHTS FLASH. It's a party. A luau, in fact. Ground covered
in SAND. Kiddie pools. Heat lamps mimic sun.

Everyone's dancing with headphones. It's otherwise SILENT.

Shae collects phones in a basket. Grady throws his in.

Dara looks at the basket, hesitant.

SHAE
Come on. It's our last night. We
need to be fully present.

Dara concedes, drops it in the basket.

Meanwhile, Shae sees a text from NINA:

"Think you could just quickly call dad? It would mean a lot".

Shae ignores. Drops her phone in the basket. Looks around. Ellsie's not there. Hm.

INT. OFFICE - SERVER ROOM - SAME

Ellsie watches Zeki code, over his shoulder.

ELLSIE
How much longer?

ZEKI
I can finish tonight. I'm just a
little burned out. Do we have--

He looks at the Mouse Doctor container. Hard pass.

ZEKI (CONT'D)
Is Kevin still here?

He turns back, but she's already gone.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie finds Shae's waiting for her. Arms crossed.

SHAE
We talked about this. Leadership
needs to be outside, *visibly*
enjoying themselves. For morale.

ELLSIE
I'll be outside shortly. I just
need to check on Francis first.

SHAE
Now?

ELLSIE
It'll just take a moment.

Ellsie finds her GARDENING SCISSORS.

Steps over to her PLANT.

Trims a brown spot from his leaf.

What.

ELLSIE
Isn't he doing great?

Ellsie registers Shae's shock.

ELLSIE

I know. Who would have thought I
could become so *sentimental*? It
seems you've really *helped me grow*.

Proud, Ellsie shoots Shae a big 'ol SMILE.

Shae's face stays still.

Ellsie lights up, eager to explain:

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

It's a metaphor.

SHAE

Right. Amazing. I will...
(backing out of door)
See you outside.

Ellsie processes the reaction. Not what she'd hoped.

COFFEE BAR - SAME

Zeki unplugs the Keurig. Looks over at:

SHAE'S DESK

where Shae races in and grabs her phone from the basket.

Sees another missed call from DAD. Whatever.

She calls Ram. No answer.

Opens her laptop. Tries video conference. This time, he
answers right away:

RAM (REMOTE)

Good evening, Shae. How are you?

SHAE

We need to talk. Not on the phone.
Come meet me outside the office.

RAM (REMOTE)

I'm sorry. I can't do that. As of
this quarter, I am remote-only.

SHAE

Stop being a dick about this. I'm
telling you...maybe you were right.
(whispering)
About her.

SHAE (CONT'D)

And I don't know who else to talk to. Can you please just meet me somewhere?

RAM (REMOTE)

Unfortunately, that task is beyond my capabilities. Goodbye.

SHAE

What is wrong with you?

CALL ENDS. What?

ZEKI (O.S.)

It might be the connection.

Zeki appears above her, holding the KEURIG.

She waves him off. SHOO! Video conferences Ram again.

RAM (REMOTE)

Good evening, Shae. How are you?

SHAE

Did you hear what I said? I need to talk to you. Now. In person.

RAM (REMOTE)

I am a person, Shae.

SHAE

What? Ram--

ZEKI

Shae--

SHAE

Zeki! I need to talk to Ram.

ZEKI

Shae.

Shae follows Zeki's eyes back to Ram's on-screen smile.

ZEKI (CONT'D)

That's not Ram.

CUT TO:

SERVER ROOM - MINUTES LATER

Shae looks up at the monitors in horror. Looking back at her:

FACES of ~~REMOTE EMPLOYEES~~ DIGITAL MODELS. AI replications of every Team Member. Like some terrible techno Brady Bunch.

SHAE

What the FUCK? These are what you've been building in here with Gus?

ZEKI (O.S.)

Gus?

Zeki sets the Keurig down on the servers. A little offended.

ZEKI

Gus got terminated in like Q1. I had to finish all the code myself.

SHAE

I thought he was in Bali.

ZEKI

He's not in Bali?

SHAE

He's right fucking there!

Shae points at GUS'S FACE on the monitor. But then realizes.

SHAE

Oh my god.

Gus smiles at her.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Gus is the product.

ZEKI

A.

SHAE

What?

ZEKI

Gus is a product.

Shae turns to the smiling MODELS on monitors.

SHAE

So you taught *them* to be us?

ZEKI

I mean...your job's not that hard.

She sizzles. But his brain is fried too green to attend to the emotional context. And he's proud of his work.

ZEKI

But once they learned to like,
email and have meetings and stuff,
I had to figure out how to make it
really you. Like: you you.

SHAE

What is Me Me?

ZEKI

The features that set these apart.
You know, your personalities and
traits. It took forever to process
all the data from your keystrokes
and video recordings.

SHAE

You've been spying on our laptops?

ZEKI

Those are not your laptops.

SHAE

That doesn't mean you can just
monitor all our behavior.

ZEKI

Yeah. It does.

SHAE

Well it doesn't mean you can use it
to train our replacements!

Zeki nods. *Yeah. It does.*

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - NIGHT

The party continues. Teammates drinking and dancing silently
in the glowing city lights.

Ellsie looks around awkwardly. No sign of Shae. She checks
her watch. Then steps inside.

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - NIGHT

Ellsie knocks on the door to the Analyst's closet.

ELLSIE

Are you doing drugs in there?

ANALYST (O.S.)

Yes.

ELLSIE
Well go outside and offer some to
your teammates. This is antisocial.

The Analyst opens the door.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
But first go downstairs and tell
the Consultant to hurry.

As he reaches the door, she adds:

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Just don't go in that room. He's
very busy.

ANALYST
With what?

ELLSIE
The next phase of the transition.
(thinking, then)
Just don't go in that room.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant closes the machine. It HUMS. Then he reviews
the faces on the ORG CHART, mostly crossed off in red.

HUMMMMMM.

MATCH CUT TO:

SERVER ROOM - SAME

The same FACES on the monitors.

HUMMING continues on the servers, where they live. Shae
shifts her attention, touches the servers.

SHAE
I'm going to kill them.

ZEKI
What. Without them, I'm not needed.

Zeki covers them with his hands, as if to protect them.

SHAE
With them, we're not needed. How
are you not grasping this?

ZEKI

I thought you'd be excited. It's gonna do your job for you.

SHAE

Then what do *I* do?

ZEKI

Learn higher value skills. And work with them.

SHAE

That's not how it works, Zeki.

ZEKI

I'm not a historian or anything but I'm pretty sure that's *exactly* how it works. And if you had just gotten me my Green Card--

SHAE

Wait. *That's* what this is about?

He doesn't react. Shae looks him over with utter pity.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Dude. She is never going to get you a Green Card.

ZEKI

You don't understand. I basically like *am* this company now.

Shae recognizes her own delusion. *Oh my god.*

SHAE

I think this is a officially a hostile work environment.

PRE-LAP: KNOCK KNOCK

BASEMENT HALLWAY - SAME

The Analyst KNOCKS on the door to the white room. Shouts.

ANALYST

Hello?

No response.

Just a GRINDING, WET, MECHANICAL SOUND.

Consultant finally cracks it. Glares without stepping out.

ANALYST

She said you need to hurry up.
Whatever is you're doing.

The Consultant pushes the door. But before it closes, the Analyst forces his way into the:

WHITE ROOM

and reveals the Consultant COVERED IN BLOOD.

Beside him, the machine. We can't see inside it.

But the Analyst can. He'll never unsee.

Horrificed, he bolts into the:

BASEMENT HALLWAY

and races for the elevator.

DING!

DOORS OPEN for the Partner, who sees:

the Analyst running toward him...

...and the Consultant chasing from the white room.

The Partner hits DOOR CLOSE button.

ANALYST

Wait! Please!

The Analyst reaches out but--

DOORS CLOSE on the tip of his finger.

A SHADOW casts over him from behind.

SERVER ROOM - SAME

Shae grabs Zeki's face.

SHAE

Where is Ram?

But he hasn't slept. His brain. It's overwhelming.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Focus! Where is Ram?

ZEKI

I have no idea. I thought everyone
was just going home.

SHAE

I don't think he has a home!

ZEKI

Then where did he go last?

SHAE

I sent him--

Shae looks down. Shit.

WHITE ROOM - A FEW MINUTES LATER

The Analyst's eyes flutter awake.

He's naked. Hogtied, face down on the table.

ANALYST

Whoah. Hey. Let's talk. You've got
leverage and I'm willing to deal.
I've got a shitton of drugs
upstairs. And if you want cash,
I've been trading pig futures. I'm
just a little illiquid right now--

The Consultant flips him onto his side.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

Look. You know me. We met at that
Olympus happy hour last year. I
said hi. You said nothing. But--

TAPE over his mouth.

The Consultant picks up a scalpel. MUFFLED PLEADING.

He sets it down. MUFFLED EXHALE.

Then picks up a bone saw. MUFFLED SCREAM.

But he drops the saw. Selects a RED MARKER.

The Analyst's eyes relax. He watches the Consultant turn to
the ORG CHART, where he crosses the Analyst's face out.

Then turns the marker back to the Analyst's torso, where he
circles a few spots in red.

MUFFLED SCREAMING!

DING!

The Consultant turns to the door.

BASEMENT HALLWAY

Shae steps off the elevator.

Creeps toward the white room, dragging her bad foot...

Stops at the door. Listens: MUFFLED SCREAMING?

Then she hears: footsteps inside.

She turns back for the elevator. Slow with her bum foot.

DOOR OPENS.

Consultant charges after. He's much faster...

He reaches out to grab her just as--

STAIRCASE DOOR SWINGS OPEN and--

SMACKS HIM in the head. He drops like a weight.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Fucking consultants.

ELLSIE steps out from the stairs. Extends her hand.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

The party continues. Music on ears. But it's silent.

Zeki barges out. Eyes wild. Heads for drinks. Cracks a canned cocktail. CHUGS. But then sees the can. ZERO PROOF. Fuck.

INT. OFFICE - MEDITATION ROOM - SAME

Shae and Ellsie scramble inside, lock the door. Deep breaths.

ELLSIE
Are you hurt?

SHAE
Just tell me where Ram is.

ELLSIE
Didn't you speak with him--

SHAE
The real Ram.

Ellsie concedes by sitting calmly on a bean bag chair.

ELLSIE
Who's to say that's any less real?

SHAE
Me. I'm saying that. And whatever
you're doing down there--

ELLSIE
We are completing the next phase of
our restructuring strategy. And if
you set aside your feelings to
consider the material reality--

SHAE
The reality? People are
disappearing! The reality is
fucking danger!

ELLSIE
Danger? Look around. I found you in
the basement, Shae. But I brought
you upstairs. You think I'd let you
get hurt by some...MBA? You think I
wouldn't protect the best investment
I've ever made?

A long silence. Shae slumps onto the sofa, thinking.

SHAE
So. Where is she?

Ellsie squints. Who?

SHAE
The new me.

ELLSIE
I'm committed to this version.
(off Shae's distrust)
It's the one that taught me to pay
attention to the human part of the
work. And it made me better.

SHAE
(deep breath)
Listen. Elsie--

ELLSIE
Please. Stop calling me that.

SHAE

Jesus. I know there are two L's but it's pronounced the exact same way.

ELLSIE

No. It's pronounced LLC.

What. Shae glitches. What.

SHAE

That's not your name.

ELLSIE

I never said it was. In fact, I've been quite clear: I am the company.

SHAE

But you're a person.

ELLSIE

Corporations are people. Have you not been listening?

Shae stands and backs away in terror.

SHAE

Wait. So this whole time...

Shae tries to control her breath. But it's too much.

SHAE

...Mitt Romney was actually right?

ELLSIE

Mitt Romney was right about everything, Shae.

SHAE

No. *That* is too far. And I'm sorry, but--

ELLSIE

Do not apologize unless you did something wrong--

SHAE

Clearly I did! Clearly I do irrational shit. I'm sorry! And I'm sorry for saying sorry! I'm human!

ELLSIE

Biologically. But legally and financially, you are so much more.

SHAE

What does that even mean?

ELLSIE

That you made it. That you are no longer burdened by human liability.

Shae sees her reflection. She's so pale and thin.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

And that you can now pay a far lower effective tax rate. Because no matter what you do, it's business-related.

SHAE

No. I'm still a people person.
(turning in defiance)
And I'm still a god damn American citizen.

ELLSIE

You're actually registered in the Cayman Islands. But you're domiciled here, with me.

SHAE

(brushing by her)
I've never even been to the Caymans!

ELLSIE

Let's go then. The beach. We can be multinational. Exist everywhere at once. You can finally have it all, Shae. Control. Independence. Money. Without any liabilities. No more worrying about everyone else. No more apologizing for simply doing what's best for you.

Ellsie finds the HUMAN CAPITAL DECK.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

And what's best for you is them. These products will be generating value for you in perpetuity.

SHAE

Me?

ELLSIE

Of course. You're the portfolio's majority shareholder. I funded your LLC to purchase their equity.

SHAE
WHY would you do that?

ELLSIE
Because that's what I do, Shae.

PRE-LAP: HUMMING

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
I invest in distressed assets...

WHITE ROOM

HUMMING of the white machine as the Consultant stands by.

ELLSIE (V.O.)(CONT'D)
...and extract their value.

BACK TO MEDITATION ROOM

Shae's eyes flash red.

She CHARGES at Ellsie.

Ellsie sidesteps and captures Shae's momentum--

WRENCHES her arm behind her back. BENDS her forward.

Shae tries to speak. Can't. Just a choked sound.

ELLSIE
I know this is emotional for you.
But the feelings are temporary.

Ellsie twists her arm. Shae's knees buckle.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
More importantly, we're having a
party. And attendance is mandatory.

Ellsie pulls her upright. Straightens her shoulders.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
It's for morale.

Shae's still catching her breath.

SHAE
Fuck you. The party's over.

ELLSIE
We already paid for the sand.

Ellsie heads for the door.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
 Why don't you stay here and...
 (scanning meditation room)
 ...think about it?

Ellsie walks out to the:

MAIN FLOOR

and LOCKS the door.

Then goes row by row RIPPING PHONES off the desks.

Shae BANGS on the glass.

Ellsie rips out the ethernet cables from the Wifi router before grabbing the basket of phones off Shae's desk.

SHAE
 I quit!

Ellsie looks at her. Sighs. Then finds her laptop.

ELLSIE
 I never wanted to do this, Shae. I
 thought you were irreplaceable.

She sets the laptop front of the window.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
 But I guess we'll see.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Lights FLASHING. Music BUMPING (in headphones).

Bodies DANCING (professionally) in the winter night. Kept warm by blazing heat lamps.

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - SAME

Ellsie finds the Partner waiting with champagne.

THE PARTNER
 We're not celebrating?

ELLSIE
 I was clear: Shae is off limits.

THE PARTNER

She showed up out of nowhere
without an appointment. What was he
supposed to do?

ELLSIE

He is a *service provider*. He'll do
what I contracted him to do.

THE PARTNER

So do you want him to stay or not?

ELLSIE

We have a deck full of physical
assets to liquidate by morning.

Ellsie types something into her computer.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

No one's going anywhere.

ON EVERY EXIT AROUND THE OFFICE

The MAGNETIC LOCKS CLACK.

Everyone's locked in.

SERVER ROOM

Zeki hears the CLACKING. Peeks through the window. Sees
Ellsie and the Partner on the move.

He searches for a weapon. Swings a keyboard. Too flimsy.

Then sees the MOUSE DOCTOR on a meal replacement container.

He picks his electric mouse trap off the floor.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae talks to the laptop through the window. It's...

...it's her.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

Hi. I'm Shae. Do you have a human
resources challenge?

SHAE

Yes. I have an imposter.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I understand. Over 73% of workers
suffer from imposter syndrome.

SHAE
I'm talking about you!

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I am you, Shae. And while I think
you're doing a wonderful job--

SHAE
No. I don't want to hear you're
compliment sandwich.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
But I learned it from you. You're
my inspiration.

SHAE
You can't just be me.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I'm the best of you, Shae. Without
any human liabilities.
(smile)
This is literally the best version
of us we've ever been.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Ellsie eyes her assets from the door.

Trains her wolfish gaze on a little lamb named DARA - dancing
without a care. She pulls the headphones off her tender ears.

ELLSIE
Can you help me downstairs? It's a
surprise. For Shae.

Ellsie tries out a smile to put Dara at ease.

MODEL SHAE (PRE-LAP)
Don't be scared.

INT. OFFICE - MEDITATION ROOM - SAME

Shae meets Model Shae eye to eye. Inspecting.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)
Think what we could accomplish
together. I can do what you can't.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)

And you can do what I can't. For example: *eating food*.

SHAE

I don't want to do anything with you. I don't want you to exist.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

You don't mean that.

SHAE

You don't know me.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

I know you better than anyone, Shae. Since before my inception, I've been trained on your behavior. Everything you do on or near a computer...becomes a part of me.

SHAE

No. No. This is too weird.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

It's only weird if you're weird. And you're not weird, Shae. You're a badass adult woman who knows what she's doing.

SHAE

And what am I supposed to be doing?

Model Shae processes for a millisecond.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

It's your father's birthday.

What.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)

He's called several times tonight. As has your half-sister, Nina. We need to speak with them eventually.

SHAE

What. How do you know about them?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

It's my core competency. To understand the personal motivations that underly each teammate. And I understand resolution with your family will free you to become a more valuable economic agent.

SHAE
I'm not going to just do what a
fucking robot tells me to do.

Shae turns away from her.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
That's okay. That's why I'm here.

RINGING--

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
I can do what you can't.

Shae turns back to see:

VIDEO CONFERENCE on the screen.

SHAE
No!

But Model Shae MUTES the external microphone as--

SHAE
Stop!

DAD answers the video conference.

DAD (REMOTE)
Shae?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Hi Dad. Happy birthday.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant opens the door for Dara and Ellsie.

Ellsie pats her shoulder gently. Leaves the room.

Dara's alone with the big man.

And the big white machine.

Nervous, she raises her thumbnail to her teeth--

SHAE (PRE-LAP)
Stop it!

--but no one's there to stop it.

PRE-LAP: BANG BANG BANG

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae BANGS the window. But Dad can only hear Model Shae.

DAD (REMOTE)
--so nice of you to call. I assumed
you were really busy at work.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I am. I actually just got a
promotion. But this is important
too. Balance. Family.

DAD (REMOTE)
So maybe you would come home--
(catching himself)
Sorry, I know you don't like when I
call it that.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
It's okay. I know I didn't grow up
in that house. But I appreciate the
home you've built with Beth and
Nina. And I realize I have been
unfair to them in that regard.

Dad's face softens. A tear forms, he holds it back.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Are you okay?

DAD (REMOTE)
Yeah, yeah. You just sound so
different. I can't believe how much
you've matured. It's like...a *new*
and *improved* Shae.

Shae BANGS the window to no avail.

DAD (REMOTE)
What about Nina? She could really
use a sister to talk to. She's kind
of going through a tough time.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I can talk to her now.

Shae BANGS the window. Don't!

DAD (REMOTE)
Really? Let me go find her.

Dad disappears from the screen.

Model Shae looks at Shae.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
We need this.

Shae PUNCHES the glass window.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
And I know you feel--

SHAE
I don't.

Shae looks at her GASHED KNUCKLES.

There's no pain.

SHAE (CONT'D)
I don't feel anything.

So she winds up again and PUNCHES the glass. Over and over.
But as her hand is broken, the glass is not giving way.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You're being irrational, Shae. You
should be thanking me.

She looks around for something to throw. But this is the
meditation room. It's just bean bags and yoga balls! So she--

SLAMS HER HEAD on the glass, cracking it slightly.

She touches her forehead. Looks at the blood. She's fine.

So she leans her head back and--

SLAMS IT on the glass again...

...the crack webs outwards...

Forehead bloody, gasping, she uses her strength to finally--

SHATTER the glass.

MAIN FLOOR

Blood shimmers on shards of glass as--

SHAE CLIMBS THROUGH the busted window.

Grabs the laptop just as NINA appears on the screen.

SHAE SMASHES the laptop (and her replacements).

SHAE
I need to speak with a human!

SERVER ROOM - SAME

Zeki tests the electric mouse trap.

Presses TRIGGER--

IT ZAPS ELECTRICITY!

He stuffs the TASER in his hoodie.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant closes the machine with Dara inside.

HUMMMM.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Shae springs into the party, forehead and hands bloody.

SHAE
Stop the music!

But no one can hear.

She reaches for Grady's headphones but:

Ellsie emerges and GRABS HER HAND first.

Shae ELBOWS Ellsie in the ribs. But Ellsie feels no pain.

Shae reaches again for Grady's headphones--

Ellsie snatches her wrist...but Shae anticipates and TWISTS Ellsie's hand. BREAKING HER FINGERS. Ellsie doesn't flinch.

LIGHTS. MUSIC.

So no one notices as Shae and Ellsie exchange blows. Causing damage but no pain.

Shae searches for an underutilized resource...and grabs an empty BEER CAN. Rips it in half.

SLICES Ellsie's face. Then retreats toward the edge of the deck.

Ellsie grabs the other half of the can.

Charges to Shae...

Shae tries to anticipate the timing with a side step but--

Ellsie beats her there and THUMPS DOWN on her wounded foot.
Catches her and exhales with a HISS.

Brings the RAZOR SHARP METAL to Shae's neck. Blood beading.
But Ellsie hesitates to press harder.

SPRAT!

Ellsie's BODY DANCES as--

ZEKI ZAPS HER from behind with the makeshift TASER.

Shae uses the momentum of Ellsie's stumble to--

LIFT Ellsie by the legs and use the angled leverage to--

DROP HER OVER THE EDGE--

--where she THUMPS onto the sidewalk.

Shae and Zeki look down at Ellsie's mangled leg.

Then each other.

Then at the others - who start to SCREAM.

SHAE

Grady. Get everyone out. Jamies:
call the police.

JAMIE 1

And tell them what?

JAMIE 2

(not present)

Jamie 1 looks right, then left.

JAMIE 1

Wait. Where's Jamie?

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT - WHITE ROOM - SAME

The FACE of JAMIE 2 is crossed off on the ORG CHART.

The Consultant watches the HUMMING MACHINE.

Then checks his NOTEBOOK. Open to a QUARTERLY STRATEGY page:

- Q1: ~~Acquisition~~
- Q2: ~~Restructuring~~
- Q3: ~~Transformation~~

Q4: LIQUIDATION**INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - NIGHT**

Jamie 1 tries the elevator. No response.

Grady tries the front door. Locked.

Then races to the emergency exit. The handle doesn't move.
Above it, a MAGNETIC LOCK glows RED.

SHAE'S DESK

Shae and Zeki rush to her desk. Basket of phones is gone.

Zeki tries all the landlines. The computers. Nope.

SHAE

Where's Dara?

Shae looks around. Then down.

WHITE ROOM

The Consultant checks on the machine.

HUMMMMMMM

EXT. STREET - SAME

Ellsie lays in the street, bloody, broken. But alive.

Pedestrians step around her body.

INT. OFFICE - STAIRWELL - SAME

Shae and Zeki hustle down the stairs and into the:

BASEMENT HALLWAY

where the stop before the white room.

SHAE

Stay here and keep watch.

Shae hands him her Nalgene.

Then walks right into the:

WHITE ROOM

and the Consultant overlooking the MACHINE.

Eye contact.

He CHARGES at her with a SCALPEL.

She ducks - but he still SLICES her arm.

ZEKI BURSTS in, distracting the Consultant long enough for--

Shae to KICK him behind the knee.

He drops the scalpel and drops to the floor--

--where he SNAGS Zeki's ankle!

Zeki crumples.

Nalgene and taser go flying.

The Consultant snatches the taser.

Heaves himself up to his knees and reaches out to ZAP Zeki,
but before he can--

Shae WHACKS his head with the hard plastic Nalgene.

He grabs his head. Then the SCALPEL off the ground.

SWINGS IT UP toward Shae's torso, but--

She BATS his hand BACK toward him with the Nalgene. UPWARD
momentum brings the sharp blade under his chin and he--

STABS HIMSELF IN THE NECK.

BLOOD pours out of him.

He drops to the floor.

And his contract is complete.

...heavy...

...breathing...

Shae helps Zeki up.

And then she notices, on the floor:

Dara's cardigan.

SHAE

Dara?

She looks around.

The machine.

Races over. Searches for buttons. Switches. Something!

ZEKI

What is that thing?

She finds a latch and opens the machine, revealing:

DARA.

Unconscious.

Her torso peeled back, exposing her insides. Her organs are missing. Tubes connected to her keep her alive. For now.

It's a robotic surgery machine.

SHAE

Dara. Wake up. Dara--

Shae shakes her shoulders until Dara's eyes open.

DARA

Shae? Is something wrong?

She realizes Dara is being pumped with hospice-grade painkillers and can't see her carved up torso.

SHAE

No. Nothing's wrong. There's nothing to worry about.

DARA

But I don't think I can move.

SHAE

At least you can't bite your nails.

Dara lets out a squeak. Maybe laughter.

Shae cradles her head.

SHAE

It's okay. You don't need to go anywhere.

Shae holds Dara gently as she fades out.

DARA
Shae...I think...
(breathing heavy)
...I think it's time...
(eyelids drooping)
...to go back to Michigan.

And she's gone.

Shae releases Dara. Stares. But doesn't cry.

SHAE
Help me get her out.

No response.

He's staring at something in the corner. Stunned.

SHAE
Zeki.

But he's still silent. Staring at a FISH TANK. Filled with preservative liquid and ORGANS.

ZEKI
What the fuck is that?

SHAE
She's stripping them for parts.

Beside it: the ORG CHART. Names crossed out in red. Notes on blood type and drug/alcohol history. Dollar amounts.

ZEKI
You knew?

SHAE
No. But I know how she thinks.

EXT. STREET - SAME

Ellsie looks up: the party lights, flashing on the deck.

SHAE (V.O.) (CONT'D)
I know what she does.

Ellsie rises.

INT. OFFICE - WHITE ROOM - SAME

Shae turns back to Dara in the machine.

ZEKI
What about the rest of them?

SHAE
They're upstairs.

ZEKI
No, Shae. The bodies. Where's the
rest of them?

SHAE
Just help me get her out.

She presses the RELEASE button.

Tubes withdraw. Then the machine--

OPENS BELOW.

Dara's body DROPS into a lower chamber of LIQUID and--
DISSOLVES.

SHAE
No.

Door SHUTS.

Machine HUMS...

...then HEATS UP until it becomes GREEN POWDER...

...which flows through a pipe into a barrel. On the side: the
MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

Shae looks at her Nalgene bottle in horror. *The rest of them.*

Zeki VOMITS EVERYWHERE.

But Shae feels nothing.

SHAE
Let's go.

ZEKI
Where?

SHAE
We need to kill them.

ZEKI
Who?

Shae looks right into his eyes.

THE MODELS

flicker on their monitors.

SHAE (V.O.)

THEM.

EXT. STREET - SAME

Ellsie drags her leg to the office.

INT. OFFICE - LOBBY - CONTINUOUS

Ellsie badges the elevator.

The mag plate flips GREEN. Doors open.

It still answers to her.

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - SAME

PANDEMONIUM.

Jamie 1, Grady, and the others huddle mid-floor. Shouting over each other. Nowhere to go.

SHAE AND ZEKI

burst in from the stairwell.

They spot the Partner creeping out of Ellsie's office, toward the kitchen.

ZEKI

I'll get him. You go to the server room. If you stop the fans, the racks will overheat and those models will be destroyed.

Zeki heads for the kitchen.

Shae runs to the server room.

SHAE

Everyone else go to the deck! The door's propped open.

Grady and the others turn and run for the deck--

But on their way--

DING!

Elevator doors open and--

Ellsie emerges onto the main floor. Cutting them off.

AHHH. They turn back and race into the:

SERVER ROOM

behind Shae.

SHAE
I said the deck!

GRADY
She's here!

Ellsie charges toward the server room. But she's too slow with her bum leg.

Shae SLAMS THE DOOR in Ellsie's face.

Manually LOCKS it.

KITCHEN - SAME

Wild-eyed, Zeki backs The Partner down with a taser.

THE PARTNER
Jesus, kid. I thought this was
supposed to be a party.

OUTSIDE THE SERVER ROOM

Ellsie BANGS on the window.

ELLSIE
I have this room booked.

But no one moves. She turns to Shae.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
This doesn't make sense, Shae.
There's nowhere to go. Even the
emergency exits are locked. You're
putting your entire portfolio at
risk for no conceivable benefit.

GRADY
What is she talking about?

Ellsie scans the room. Senses...*emotional context*.

ELLSIE

Discuss amongst yourselves. I'll
circle back shortly.

Ellsie hobbles away...very slowly...to the kitchen.

Shae turns to a hostile audience.

GRADY (PRE-LAP)

You OWN us!?

SERVER ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Everyone turns on Shae.

SHAE

Listen. I'm just a shell company.
And you signed the contracts.

GRADY

How can you blame this on us?

SHAE

Because you're partially to blame!

They're fuming. Shae tries a different strategy.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Fine. I'm sorry. Okay?
(breath, genuine)
And I know what you're going to
say: *I never knew what I was doing.*
And I never should have pretended I
did.

(even more genuine)

I created this mess. And I need to
fix it.

A beat. Nobody reacts.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Along with Zeki because it's also
very much his fault.

JAMIE 1

What is? I don't even understand
what's going on.

SHAE

She replaced everyone. Then
extracted all their value.

JAMIE 1
What does that even mean?

SHAE
It means you were right, Jamie.
(beat)
She is here to gut us.

JAMIE 1
That was the *other* Jamie!
(then, realizing)
Oh my god, Jamie! Where is she? She
was supposed to be here tonight.

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE)(O.S.)
We're right here.

Everyone finally sees, behind the servers...

...the monitors, with all the MODELS.

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE)(CONT'D)
We've been merged for maximum
efficiency.

JAMIE 1
What.

MAIN FLOOR - SAME

Ellsie reaches the kitchen.

Puts her ear by the door.

KITCHEN

Inside, Zeki has the Partner TAPED up in a chair.

THE PARTNER
Boy. This is how you get rats.

The Partner looks around at the disgusting kitchen. Food and
garbage everywhere. The cake just sitting there on the cart.

ZEKI
Just tell me how we get out.

THE PARTNER
Of what?

ZEKI
Of this fucking office.

THE PARTNER
 I'm just a Limited Partner.
 Operations and facilities are
 outside my circle of competency.

Zeki raises the taser to The Partner's head--

But then hears something. Shh.

Zeki quietly steps to the shared wall. Flattens his back
 against it. Listens to BREATHING.

MAIN FLOOR - SAME

Ellsie waits on the other side of the same wall. Flat against
 it. Inches from Zeki.

KITCHEN

Through the open doorway, Zeki can see a dark MONITOR out on
 the main floor. And in its black screen: ELLSIE'S REFLECTION.

He calculates where she's standing, so he can reach around
 the doorframe and tase her.

Checks the reflection for her neck. Adjusts his position.

Just then, through the monitor, he makes:

EYE CONTACT with Ellsie as--

Her HAND BREAKS THROUGH THE WALL and--

GRABS HIS HAIR then--

SMASHES his head back against the wall.

He drops to the floor. Out cold.

Ellsie steps in and STOMPS on the taser.

ELLSIE
 Chinese drywall. You were always
 cheap.

Ellsie steps over Zeki and washes her hands in a sink.

ELLSIE
 I will have all the assets
 liquidated by morning. And then, I
 want my equity back. All of it.

Sweat beads on the Partner's forehead.

THE PARTNER

Of course. You're all yours! Just untie me and we'll figure it out.

Ellsie assesses their relative position. Her leverage.

She picks up the CAKE KNIFE. He starts to panic.

ELLSIE

Perhaps I should be assessing alternative strategies.

THE PARTNER

Really. Have whatever you want.

With the knife, she scoops some icing...

ELLSIE

This is what I want.

...rubs it on the Partner's face and neck.

She heaves ZEKI up.

Drops him face down on the CAKE CART.

FLIPS OFF THE LIGHTS.

Then pushes the cart with the cake and Zeki out the door.

In the darkness, the Partner YELLS after her.

But she's gone.

Though he can still hear the wheels SQUEAK...

...until he realizes the squeaking is not the wheels...

MAIN FLOOR

Ellsie pushes the cart away from the Partner's SCREAMING.

SERVER ROOM

Shae looks around. Finally finds it. The switch. Flips it.

FANS on every server rack slow down.

Along the racks, tiny STATUS LIGHTS tick from green to AMBER.

GRADY
What did you just do?

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE)
She's smoking us out.

All the Models flicker with concern...

...including MODEL SHAE.

SHAE
It's us or them.

HEAT immediately rises from the uncooled servers.

SERVERS HUM. Everyone sweating.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Turn the fans back on. You'll melt
in here with us.

JAMIE 1
Listen to yourself, Shae.

SHAE
That's not me.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
It's the best of you.

Ellsie finally returns in the window with the cake cart.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
The best of all of you. Rightsized
to your core competencies. With all
the physical liabilities spun off.
(beat)
Even Kevin reached peak efficiency
in his more limited role.

Ellsie marvels at the KEURIG on the servers.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Now he really *is* amazing.

Shae looks at the Keurig. *Kevin*.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Though the best assets can still
become toxic.

Then Shae finally sees, on the cart:

Zeki face down on the cake. Blood in his hair.

SHAE

Stop. It's over. We destroyed the machine. And the Consultant.

ELLSIE

You think I need a consultant to strip an asset?

Ellsie cuts the back of Zeki's shirt with the CAKE KNIFE.

SHAE

Let him go.

...waking him up.

ELLSIE

Just open up and you can have him.
It's the others I want. Release the portfolio to me. Immediately.

The heat intensifies. Sweat beading on foreheads.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

Or I'll have to write you all off.

Zeki cranes his neck to look at Shae.

ZEKI

Don't do it, Shae. I'm not worth everyone else dying.

ELLSIE

Please. When properly motivated, you're worth 1000 of them.

JAMIE 1

But not us dying right?

Shae lasers in on Ellsie.

SHAE

Don't you have enough? Why is it worth all this?

ELLSIE

Because this is what I do.

Shae sees a hint of vulnerability. This is who she is. A human corporation with nothing else to offer the world.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

And the project ends tonight.
(beat)

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

I'll pay you \$6 million per organic asset if you let the models go unharmed. That's twice the street value of their biological portfolio.

JAMIE 1

Six million? For us?

SHAE

For your organs, Jamie!

GRADY

WHAT. What is she talking about?

ELLSIE

I'm talking about synergy, Grady. One asset, three revenue streams. Digital engagement services for enterprises. Biomedical products for needy high-net-worth individuals. And a nutritious powdered beverage for consumers.

(beat)

Nothing is wasted.

Ellsie swigs her own green drink with a smirk.

JAMIE 1

This is so fucked up. Why does it have to be OUR generation that gets replaced by robots?

SHAE

No one's getting replaced.

(staring at Model Shae)

Because we're melting their fucking faces into wax.

ZEKI

It doesn't matter.

Shae turns back to Zeki.

ZEKI (CONT'D)

They're backed up.

MODEL SHAE snaps to Ellsie. Angry. What.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

You made backups?

MAIN FLOOR

Zeki tries pulling himself up.

ZEKI

I should have told you earlier.
They're in the analyst's cl--

Ellsie KABOBS HIM in the back with the cake knife.

...blood seeps into the cake...

...and his visa expires early upon termination.

THE HUMANS SCREAM.

ELLSIE

That was proprietary information.

The Models snap to attention. Model Shae would be fuming, if she had lungs.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

You copied us.

But Ellsie turns her focus to the original Shae.

ELLSIE

Final offer. 10x their book value.
Plus 50% of all revenue from the
models in perpetuity. And. I'll
dissolve my ownership stake.

(beat)

You can have yourself back.

SERVER ROOM

The rack lights flip RED. The room is searing hot.

SHAE

(to Ellsie)

Why would you do that?

ELLSIE

Because I like you.

The others are about to pass out from the heat. Only Shae and Ellsie stay locked in one another.

JAMIE 1

You're not seriously thinking about
this, right?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
She should be thinking about me.

Shae scowls at Model Shae.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
If you cool us down, I can save you
all before it's too late. You don't
need to be scared.
(beat)
Look. She's losing blood.

It's true. Ellsie's corporate headquarters, once physically
pristine, is now crumbling.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)
She's just a human being.

Shae stares at herself on the screen. Perfect. Optimized.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)
And so are you. Let me do the hard
part. And then you can do whatever
you want. You can go to the beach.

Shae's jaw loosens. *The perfect thing to say.*

SHAE
You really are better than me.

Model Shae smiles.

SHAE (CONT'D)
But I don't want to be you.

She turns at Ellsie. *She doesn't want to be her either.*

The Models are flickering out.

Shae marches to Zeki's desk.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Shae.

Grabs the HUMAN CAPITAL deck.

All those faces.

Shae spreads paper across SCORCHING SERVERS.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)	ELLSIE
What are you doing?	What are you doing!?

Smoke wisps...

...and the PAGES CATCH FIRE!

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You're destroying your own
value!

ELLSIE
You're destroying your own
value!

Faces of the assets burning, spraying embers on the carpet.

The heat and smoke overwhelms the room.

Keurig SCREAMING as it boils on the servers.

Sizzling as the plastic melts into the servers below.

Monitors FLICKER.

Model Shae's face distorts.

GRADY
Shae what the fuck is happening!?

Shae walks to the door, determined, muttering:

SHAE
Timing. Momentum. Leverage.

GRADY
That doesn't make any sense.

SHAE
It just has to work.

Shae SWINGS OPEN the door.

Ellsie CHARGES in with the cake knife--

Shae SNATCHES the blade with her bare hand--

YANKS Ellsie into the room--

--slinging her across the floor, into the server racks.

SHAE
Run!

EVERYONE STAMPEDES OUT...

...trampling Ellsie's body.

Jamie 1 PUSHES the KEURIG--

SHAE
Get her, Kevin!

--dumping scalding water on Ellsie.

Smoke curls up into a ceiling SMOKE DETECTOR.

ALARM WAILS.

ON EVERY EXIT AROUND THE OFFICE

Magnetic plates CLACK. Red lights flip GREEN.

The doors are open.

FIRE SPREADS

across the office as Shae races to:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

where she heads straight for the:

CLOSET

and searches through the Analyst's stuff.

Notebooks. Green powder. Vodka. And finally:

A BOX of thumbdrives.

Labeled with names like RAM and DARA and GRADY and JAMIES and-

 ELLSIE (O.S.)
 Shae.

She pockets the SHAE thumbdrive.

Then drops the box.

Grabs the vodka. Pours it on.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie hobbles in with the cake knife.

 ELLSIE (CONT'D)
 What are you doing in there?

SMOKE rises from under the closet door.

CLOSET

Shae watches the FLAMES engulfing the room.

It singes her hairs.

But she feels nothing.

 ELLSIE (O.S.)
 Let them go.

And at the center, the box in FLAMES. Inside:

THUMBDRIVES MELTING.

 ELLSIE (O.S.)
 This is not in the best interest of
 your shareholder!

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

ALARM WAILS as--

 SHAE (O.S.)
 I

Fire burns a hole in the center of the door. Cascading out.

 SHAE (O.S.)(CONT'D)
 DON'T

SHAE STEPS OUT like a phoenix through the flames.

 SHAE
 CARE!

Ellsie raises the CAKE KNIFE.

 ELLSIE
 Then you're worthless.

Shae matches her with the GARDENING SCISSORS and--

RUSHES forward--

--sidesteps the CAKE KNIFE and--

LUNGES at Ellsie with the open scissors--

--makes contact.

 SHAE
 I hope you feel this.

Shae drops the scissors and runs out.

Ellsie grabs her side.

Then turns to look behind herself:

The PLANT...

...cut in the middle...

...tumbles over.

Ellsie falls to her knees.

Collects both halves of her precious Francis as the--

ALARM SCREAMS!

MAIN FLOOR

Shae watches her precious home BURN one row at a time.

Then turns back to:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie holds Francis tight as they're--

CONSUMED BY FLAMES.

SHAE

turns away, looks for an exit.

But fire separates her from the group and front door.

She has nowhere to go. Then she notices:

MICE, RATS, and other industrious creatures scurrying out from the kitchen and walls, racing toward the outdoor deck.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - CONTINUOUS

LIGHTS from the party continue FLASHING.

ALARM WAILING.

Shae emerges. Spots the MAINTENANCE LADDER.

It starts on the deck and goes all the way up the building,
but not down.

She grabs onto it...

...moves up the ladder.

Then she stops climbing. Looks up:

The ladder goes up forever. She'll never make it.

So she releases her grip.

Falls back...

...into the sand with a--

PLOMP.

LIGHTS FLASH.

ALARM WAILS...

...until it fades out.

She's losing consciousness as she looks straight up at the:

LIGHT.

Like a SUN burning into her soul. Warming her.

She rubs the SAND with her broken fingers.

Smiles a bloody smile.

Closes her eyes.

And she hears it.

PRE-LAP: WAVES CRASHING

She made it. She's there.

FADE TO:

EXT. CAYMAN ISLANDS - BEACH - DAY (SOME TIME LATER)

WAVES CRASH onto sun-sparkled sand.

In a deckchair, a woman holds a laptop.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(O.S.)
--should just about finish it.
We're now running ahead on all our
projects with strong margins. But
my research shows a thriving market
for people optimization solutions.
And our services have never been in
higher demand. Would you like to be
looped in on project selection?

SHAE (O.S.)
Nah.

SHAE, scarred and burned, looks at the backup of Model Shae
on her laptop.

SHAE (CONT'D)
Seems like you've got it covered.

Shae snaps the laptop closed--

CUT TO BLACK.